

AI 101 Prompt Kit

How to talk to AI, and what all the words mean. Keep this next to your keyboard.

WORKS IN

Claude · ChatGPT · Gemini
Copilot · any chatbot

The 5-part prompt Use all five and your answers get better right away.

R Role

Who should the AI act like?

T Task

The one job you want done. Start with a verb.

C Context

The background: who it's for, what matters, what to avoid.

F Format

How it should look: length, tone, list or paragraph.

E Example

Show it one you like. AI copies examples really well.

BEFORE

"Write a post about my bakery."

You get something bland that sounds like everybody else.

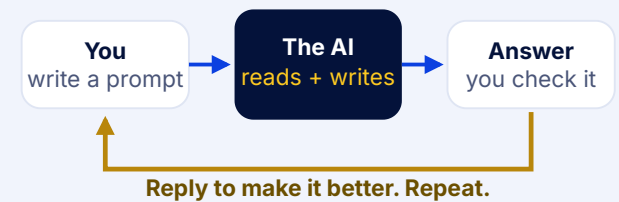
AFTER

You are a social media writer for a small family bakery. **ROLE** Write an Instagram caption for our new sweet potato pie. **TASK** It's my grandmother's recipe and we only sell it on Fridays. Our customers are busy parents who love comfort food. **CONTEXT** Keep it under 60 words, warm and friendly, and end with a question. **FORMAT** Here's a caption we loved last month: "Saturday mornings smell like cinnamon around here. Come see what's fresh before it's gone. What's your go-to Saturday treat?" **EXAMPLE**

3 rules that fix most answers

- 1 How you ask decides what you get.**
A clear, detailed ask gets a clear, useful answer.
- 2 It's a conversation, not a search.**
Reply to make the answer better. You don't have to start over.
- 3 It can be wrong and sound sure.**
Check names, numbers, dates and links before you use them.

How a chat works



15 AI words, in plain English

AI

Computer programs that do things that used to take a person, like writing, answering questions and summing things up.

Prompt

What you type to the AI: your instructions and your question.

LLM

Large Language Model. The kind of model behind chatbots. It learned from a huge amount of writing.

Frontier model

One of the most capable AI models right now. The top spot changes every few months.

Context window

Everything the AI keeps in mind: your whole chat. Long chats cost more and can forget the start.

Generative AI

AI that makes something new: words, pictures, video or music.

Follow-up

Your reply that steers the answer, like "shorter" or "give me 3 more".

Training data

Everything the model learned from. It's why AI can be out of date.

AGI

Artificial general intelligence: a future AI that could do any thinking task a person can. It doesn't exist yet.

Custom instructions

Your background and rules, saved once so you don't retype them. They carry into your new chats. A Claude Project is similar, but only for chats inside that Project.

Chatbot

An AI you talk to by typing. Claude, ChatGPT and Gemini are chatbots.

Model

The "brain" behind the chatbot. Some models are faster, some are smarter.

Token

A small piece of text: a short word, part of a longer word, or a mark like a period. AI reads, writes and counts in tokens.

Hallucination

When AI makes something up and says it like a fact. That's why you check.

Agent

An AI set up to do a whole job for you. It can use tools and take steps on its own. Set it up once, and it can do the job again and again. That's the October 23 workshop.

Save it once: your "About me," so every chat knows you

Claude: Settings → Instructions for Claude, or a Project

ChatGPT: Settings → Personalization → Custom instructions

Gemini: Settings & help → Personal context

Use it tonight

Fill in your own prompt, steer the answer, and fix what goes wrong.

AI 101

Friday, October 9 · 7 to 8 PM CT

Fill in your prompt

R Role _____

T Task _____

C Context _____

F Format _____

E Example _____

Say this next

- Make it shorter. Make it sound like me: [HOW YOU TALK].
- Give me 3 more options. Explain that more simply.
- Put that in a table. Ask me 3 questions first, then try again.
- Make it warmer. Make it more professional. What's missing?
- Turn it into a checklist.

When something goes wrong

The answer is too generic.

Add the Context and an Example. Or say: "Ask me 3 questions first, then try again."

It says it can't help.

Say what you need and why, in plain words. It may say no on purpose to anything harmful. For medical, legal or money questions, it can help you get ready, but don't rely on it as professional advice.

It made something up.

Ask: "Which parts should I check, and where?" Don't trust a "yes, I'm sure." Check names, numbers, dates and links in a second source you find yourself.

It forgot what I said earlier.

Long chats can lose the start. Ask it: "Sum up this chat so I can start a new one." Then open a new chat and paste that summary.

I hit a limit.

Free plans have limits. It can be how much you send, or extras like photos, images and voice. The tool tells you when it resets. Wait a bit, or switch tools. Your prompts work in all three.

I lost my chat.

Your old chats are listed in the menu on the left. On the phone, open the menu first. Chats you start in Incognito or Temporary mode are not saved. Keep your best prompts in a note on your phone so you can reuse them.

Never paste

- Passwords, PINs or security codes
- Social Security, bank or card numbers
- Other people's private information, like health details, addresses or phone numbers
- Customer or client information
- Employee information, like reviews, pay or medical notes
- Company secrets. At work, follow your company's AI rules.

Pasted something by mistake? Delete that chat. At work, tell your manager or IT right away.

At work, ask one question: "Which AI tools can I use, and what can I put in them?"

Notes

AT WORK

A clear email

You are a friendly, professional coworker. Write an email to [WHO] about [WHAT]. They need to know [THE KEY DETAILS]. Keep it under 120 words, polite and direct, and end with a clear ask.

Meeting notes into a summary

Here are my notes from a meeting: [PASTE YOUR NOTES, WITH NO PRIVATE OR CUSTOMER INFORMATION]. Turn them into a short summary with three parts: what we decided, who is doing what, and by when. Use bullet points.

Reply to an upset customer

You are a calm, kind customer service writer. A customer wrote this: [PASTE THEIR MESSAGE, WITH THEIR NAME AND DETAILS REMOVED]. Write a reply that says sorry, explains what happens next, and offers [WHAT YOU CAN DO]. Under 100 words.

YOUR OWN BUSINESS

A social media caption

You are a social media writer for [YOUR BUSINESS]. Write an Instagram caption about [WHAT YOU'RE POSTING]. My customers are [WHO THEY ARE]. Keep it under 60 words, warm, and end with a question.

Answers to the questions you always get

Here are the questions my customers ask most: [LIST THEM]. Write a short, friendly answer to each one that I can save and paste whenever someone asks.

A no-pressure follow-up

Write a short text to someone who asked about [YOUR SERVICE] last week but hasn't booked. Friendly, no pressure, under 40 words, ending with one easy next step.

HOME AND FAMILY

A meal plan on a budget

Plan 5 weeknight dinners for [NUMBER] people for under \$[AMOUNT] total. We like [FOODS]. Allergies or things we don't eat: [LIST, OR NONE]. Give me the meals, then one shopping list grouped by store aisle.

A birthday message

Write a heartfelt birthday message for my [WHO], who is turning [AGE]. Mention [A FAVORITE MEMORY]. Warm and a little funny, under 80 words.

A church or community announcement

Write a short announcement for our [CHURCH, CLUB OR GROUP]'s [EVENT] on [DATE]. Say what to bring and who to call with questions. Friendly, under 100 words, and easy to read out loud.

MONEY AND TIME

A simple budget

My monthly take-home pay is \$[AMOUNT]. My bills are: [LIST EACH ONE AND WHAT IT COSTS]. Build me a simple monthly budget, show what's left over, and give me three realistic ways to save \$[AMOUNT] a month.

Plan your week

Here's everything I need to do this week: [LIST]. I work [YOUR HOURS]. Put it into a realistic day-by-day plan with the most important things first.

Make a decision

I'm choosing between [OPTION A] and [OPTION B]. What matters most to me: [LIST]. Make a simple pros-and-cons table, then ask me two questions that would help me decide.

LEARN ANYTHING

Explain it like I'm new

Explain [TOPIC] to me like I'm brand new to it. Use an everyday example, keep it under 150 words, then ask me one question to check I understood.

Quiz me

Quiz me on [TOPIC], one question at a time. Wait for my answer, tell me if I'm right, and explain gently if I'm not. Start easy and get harder.

Learn a new skill in 30 days

I want to learn [SKILL] in 30 days with [TIME] a day. Make me a simple week-by-week plan, and tell me what kinds of free resources to look for.